Theme 4: Innovation

The Best and the Worst Inventions

Lesson 4-3
Book pages 54-55

💡 **Big idea:** Some inventions are **helpful** (writing systems, paper, money, medicine, the wheel); others are **harmful** (cigarettes, cars' pollution, guns, fast food, nuclear weapons).

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Discuss helpful and harmful inventions
- Find specific information
- Increase vocabulary through reading

📖 Key words

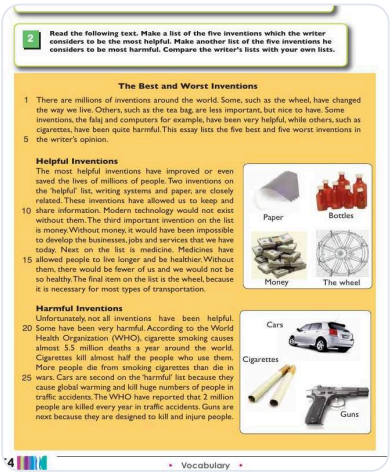
harmful ضار	**helpful** نافع	**global warming** الاحتباس الحراري
nuclear weapon سلاح نووي	**essay** مقال	**transportation** النقل

Helpful inventions

- writing systems and paper: keep and share information
- money: businesses and services
- medicine: longer, healthier lives
- the wheel: needed for most transportation
- the falaj is another helpful invention

Harmful inventions

- cigarettes: kill millions every year (WHO)
- cars: global warming and road accidents
- guns: designed to kill
- fast food: harmful to health
- nuclear weapons: destroy cities



2 Read the following text. Make a list of the five inventions which the writer considers to be the most helpful. Make another list of the five inventions he considers to be most harmful. Compare the writer's lists with your own lists.

The Best and Worst Inventions

There are millions of inventions around the world. Some, such as the wheel, have changed the way we live. Others, such as the tea bag, are less important, but nice to have. Some inventions, the falaj and computers for example, have been very helpful, while others, such as cigarettes, have been quite harmful. This essay lists the five best and five worst inventions in the writer's opinion.

Helpful Inventions

The most helpful inventions have improved or even saved the lives of millions of people. Two inventions on the 'helpful' list, writing systems and paper, are closely related. These inventions have allowed us to keep and share information. Modern technology would not exist without them. The third important invention on the list is money. Without money, it would have been impossible to develop the businesses, jobs and services that we have today. Next on the list is medicine. Medicines have allowed people to live longer and be healthier. Without them, there would be fewer of us and we would not be so healthy. The final item on the list is the wheel, because it is necessary for most types of transportation.

Paper Bottles Money The wheel

Harmful Inventions

Unfortunately, not all inventions have been helpful. Some have been very harmful. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), cigarette smoking causes almost 5.5 million deaths a year around the world. Cigarettes kill almost half the people who use them. More people die from smoking cigarettes than die in wars. Cars are second on the 'harmful' list because they cause global warming and kill huge numbers of people in traffic accidents. The WHO have reported that 2 million people are killed every year in traffic accidents. Guns are next because they are designed to kill and injure people.

Cars Cigarettes Guns

4 Vocabulary

Reading: The Best and Worst Inventions (p.54)

✏️ Examples

Why is the wheel helpful?

Answer: It is necessary for most types of transportation.

⭐ Remember

- Read extensively and choose texts at or below your level to build vocabulary.

⚠️ Watch out

- Thinking every invention is only good or only bad. → Cars help us travel but also pollute.

🧩 **Activity:** Make two lists: your five best and five worst inventions. Explain one choice.

✅ Check yourself

1. Name a helpful invention
2. Why are cars harmful?
3. What is the WHO?

Answers: (1) Paper ، (2) Global warming and accidents ، (3) World Health Organization